Alza.Services

Tenant follow-up: one-page checklist

For small property managers. Do steps 1 to 5 this week, before you automate anything.

This week

- [ ] **Count your messages.** For one week, tally every tenant message you send by type: rent reminder, late notice, renewal, maintenance update, other.
- [ ] **Pick the biggest pile.** That is your first workflow to automate.
- [ ] **Write the message once.** One template you are happy with, with the tenant's name, unit and date filled in.
- [ ] **Set the timing.** For example: rent reminder 3 days before the due date and again on the due date.
- [ ] **Write the hand-off rule.** Which replies need a person? Write them down.

Messages that follow a clear rule (automate these first)

Message	When it goes out
Rent reminder	3 days before due, and on the due date
Late-rent notice	After the grace date; flag for you 3 days later
Renewal reminder	90, 60 and 30 days before the lease ends
Maintenance update	Request received, vendor scheduled, job done
Move-in / move-out checklist	Same point every time, with reminders

Always stays with a person

- Late fees, payment plans and evictions
- Replies from an upset tenant
- Safety issues: gas, water leaks, no heat, security
- Fair housing questions, or anything where wording carries legal weight
- The first message to a new owner or a tenant with a complicated situation

Before you choose a tool or a helper

- [ ] Do I already have a system of record (leases, payments, work orders)?
- [ ] Who will maintain the rules when something changes?
- [ ] What does the full monthly price include, and is there a setup fee?
- [ ] What do I keep if I stop?